

3.2 Printers

Here are some terms common to both laser and inkjet printers.

3.2.1 Bidirectional Printing

In older printers, data could be only be sent from the PC to the printer. This meant no information about the status of the print job could be transmitted to the user. Bidirectional printing allowed the printer to convey messages to the PC, which made it easier for the user to track print progress, and be informed about the status of various parameters of the printer—ink level, for example.

3.2.2 Borderless Printing

This feature is commonly seen in printers that also offer photo printing. Normally, all printers restrict the user from printing the entire width and length of a paper, leaving a small border. But this can be manually overridden. Borderless printing is a feature that allows the creation of photos that look similar to those available from professional labs. When this setting is selected, the printer prints the entire width and length of the paper.

3.2.3 CMYK

This is the colour scheme used in printing technology. The name is derived from the four constituents of the scheme—Cyan, Magenta, Yellow, and Black. Colour inkjet printers have reservoirs for each of the colours. Some photo printers also carry additional colours like red, green, light cyan and light magenta to offer better colour fidelity.

3.2.4 Draft Mode / Ink Saving mode / Toner Saving Mode

These refer to an alternative mode of printing where the printer uses less ink or toner to print. This is also the fastest mode of printing, and is ideal for trial prints.

3.2.4 Duplex Printing

Refers to the ability to print on both sides of a page. This is managed by the printer by ordering the pages in the print queue so